ILLUSTRATION / MOTION / INTERACTIVE WEB EXPERIMENT

404 Self-Portrait

404 Self-Portrait uses the artist's own image as an entry point into a broader contemporary condition. It explores how information overload, social platforms, smart devices, and artificial intelligence destabilize our sense of identity, judgment, and human value. Here, '404' does not mean that the self has disappeared, but that within a state of constant connection, it has become increasingly difficult to distinguish our own voice from the information, expectations, and automated systems surrounding us.

INFORMATION OVERLOAD
ALGORITHMIC IDENTITY
HUMAN VALUE IN THE AGE OF AI

ASSET NEEDED

Final coloured key visual

Portrait illustration / high resolution / 4:5

Building the Inner System

Sketch, symbol, composition, and colour development

A INITIAL SKETCH

ASSET NEEDED

01-original-sketch.jpg

Initial hand-drawn sketch / 4:5

The open head transforms the mind into a space that can be entered, examined, and occupied. A small headless figure searches within this space, while the '404 NOT FOUND' sign suggests that the system cannot return a stable or complete definition of the self.

B SYMBOL EXPLORATION

ASSET NEEDED

Plugs / cables

mismatched interfaces; cables as nerves

ASSET NEEDED

Signs / windows

conflicting directions; fragmented feeds

ASSET NEEDED

Duplicated faces

partial generation and repeated identity

ASSET NEEDED

Hand / machine

handwriting versus generated copies

ASSET NEEDED

Identity record

missing names and incomplete fields

ASSET NEEDED

Body selection

cursor, scan frame, or selection box

C COMPOSITION AND COLOUR TESTS

ASSET NEEDED

composition-test-01

4:3 landscape

ASSET NEEDED

composition-test-02

4:3 landscape

ASSET NEEDED

colour-palette

3:2 landscape

Warm, muted tones represent memory and embodied experience, while cool greys, blues and desaturated greens refer to technological systems and continuous information flow. Graphite lines and paper texture remain visible beneath the colour.

Anatomy of Overconnection

FINAL ILLUSTRATION / WORK IN PROGRESS

WORK IN PROGRESS

final-colour-illustration

03-final-colour-illustration.png / 4:5 portrait

ASSET NEEDED

detail-inner-figure

1:1 crop

The Inner Figure

The remaining internal voice, reduced but not erased.

ASSET NEEDED

detail-connections

1:1 crop

Unmatched Connections

Constant connectivity does not guarantee understanding.

ASSET NEEDED

detail-fragmented-feeds

1:1 crop

Fragmented Feeds

Contradictory information accumulates faster than it can be processed.

ASSET NEEDED

detail-reproduced-self

1:1 crop

The Reproduced Self

Repeated identities question what remains uniquely human.

From Connection to Overload

The viewer's scrolling gradually introduces more information into the portrait. The act of continuing to browse becomes the mechanism that produces information overload.

01 DORMANT

ASSET NEEDED

state-01-dormant

16:10 interaction state

The figure remains quiet. The inner character walks slowly, the cables are inactive, and the sign displays '404 NOT FOUND'.

02 CONNECTED

ASSET NEEDED

state-02-connected

16:10 interaction state

Scrolling activates the cables and introduces the first fragments of external information.

03 OVERLOADED

ASSET NEEDED

state-03-overloaded

16:10 interaction state

Windows, notifications, repeated faces and contradictory messages accumulate until the inner figure is partially obscured.

04 UNRESOLVED

ASSET NEEDED

state-04-unresolved

16:10 interaction state

The flow suddenly freezes or fades into empty frames. The system becomes quiet, but no definitive answer is returned.

WEB / MOTION DEMO

interaction-demo

Browser mockup / GIF or MP4 / 16:9

INTERACTION

Scrolling does not simply reveal content. Each continued movement adds signals, windows, and copies until the portrait can no longer be read as a stable whole.

TOOLS

Illustration / Image Editing / HTML / CSS / JavaScript

ASSET NEEDED

project-link-qr

18-project-link-qr.png / 1:1

PROJECT LINK